

Item Narrative Sample Set — 5 Reference Pieces for Fina

(English translation of: 아이템 서사 샘플집 v2)

Document ID: CNT-ITM-SAMPLES-001 **Status:** Draft v2 — English translation pass (2026-05-26) **Source:** Content_Item_Narrative_Samples.md (Korean original) **Purpose:** Provide Fina (scenario writer) with tone, emotion, and structural reference for ECHORIS item narratives.

Common principles (v1 + v2):

- One person, one emotion at the center.
- Length: roughly 900–1000 English words per piece.

v2 World-Consistency Rules (sci-fi · megastructure · post-apocalypse · 20,000 years later):

1. **The Builders** have been gone for twenty thousand years. State this clearly in the first paragraph. Today, humanity survives like a thin film on the upper habitable strata of the Builder megastructure.
2. **Every tool is a Builder-era artifact, repurposed.** It had an original use; people gave it another. (E.g., the Resonance Stylus = Builder-era atmospheric seal tester; the Photon Brush = recovered from Builder maintenance equipment.)
3. **Materials are industrial:** alloy, polymer, pressure-paper, isotope-tagged pigment. Avoid pre-modern vocabulary such as wood, paper, watercolor.
4. **Mixed time units:** personal time (age, years lived) stays in "years"; work rotations (shifts, weekly returns) use "cycles." Deliberately expose macro time scales: a hundred years ago, a thousand years ago, twenty thousand years ago.
5. **Disaster is depressurization, not flood.** When a bulkhead seam opens to vacuum, everything inside is gone in a single breath. The most common ending in the megastructure.
6. **Use the Builder alloy as a mechanism:** sound conducts for kilometers; isotope pigment adheres for decades; pressure-paper does not corrode; vibrations are remembered deeply.
7. **Windows are painted skies.** Residential compartments have no real windows. There is only another bulkhead three meters away. Someone has painted a sky on it from memory.

Sample 1. Resonance Stylus (공명 첨두)

Field	Content
rarity	Normal (#FFFFFF · white)
temperament	Rust (gray · resignation)
item_type	Dagger (recovered Builder-era atmospheric seal tester)
inspiration_film	Inside Out (Bing Bong — the one who stays so as not to be forgotten)
one-line emotion	"A story about realizing that waiting was itself a form of love."
word_count	~950 words

Story

There was a Bulkhead Surveyor.

He lived in the upper habitable strata of the megastructure — a thin layer where, twenty thousand years after the Builders had gone, air still circulated and light still reached. No one alive remembers who the Builders were. What they left behind was endless alloy corridors, sealed doors that would never open again, and the great vertical Shaft falling endlessly into the deep.

His work was to survey the Shaft. The Surveyor Guild had formed about a thousand years after the Builders left. They descended below the habitable strata, mapped the deep sections, recovered Builder relics, and, sometimes, came back alive. Coming back alive was the exception.

His tool was a Resonance Stylus. The Guild issued one to each surveyor. It was a slender alloy rod with a fine point at the tip; when you tapped it against a bulkhead, the alloy rang, and you could hear, in the sound, the cracks running through it. The handle was hollow. Originally, in Builder times, it had been an atmospheric seal-tester. If you put your lips to it and blew gently, pressurized air passed through the inner chamber and made a single, clean tone. The tone traveled through Builder alloy for kilometers. Surveyors had long used it as a signal — a way to call for one another when separated in the deep corridors.

Every rest cycle he came back to their small compartment in the residential strata. He would sit at the table and carve little figures. His material was polymer offcuts that the foreman at the

recycling shop set aside for him. Polymer was soft enough that he could shape it with the survey stylus itself.

He had a daughter, seven years old. She waited for each rest cycle, and the little figures her father carved lined the windowsill of their compartment. The window was not a real window. As in every compartment of the residential strata, the place of the window opened onto another bulkhead, three meters away. Someone, long ago, had painted a sky on that bulkhead from memory.

One rest cycle, her father did not come home.

The next rest cycle, he did not come home. Nor the one after.

Her mother went to the Guild registry many times. The Guild's answer was always the same.

"A surveyor is alive for as long as his resonance trace remains in the alloy. We have not classified him as missing."

It was an old Guild regulation. The Builders had built the megastructure to last forever, and so the Guild believed that anything still moving inside it might yet be alive.

The daughter found her father's Resonance Stylus deep in a drawer of the compartment. It lay there, beside the last figure he had been carving. The figure's face was still rough polymer on one side. He had left the compartment that day with the figure unfinished.

From that day on, every rest cycle evening, the daughter went to the outer bulkhead. It was the outermost wall of the residential strata; beyond it, the deep Shaft began at once. She put the hollow handle to her lips and blew. The pure tone traveled along the Builder alloy, kilometer after kilometer, down into the dark strata below.

The first years it was a short sound. A seven-year-old's lungs cannot sustain it long. By twelve, a single tone lasted fifteen seconds. By twenty, thirty. Her lungs grew, and the tone reached deeper.

By thirty, she understood. She was not calling her father. What she was calling was the table at rest-cycle evening, the place where her father had carved, the rough unfinished side of the last figure's face. She knew it would not come back. But if she stopped calling, even that might stop being.

At forty, one rest-cycle evening, she stood at the outer bulkhead and did not blow. She only placed her palm on the alloy. The metal was cold. Under her hand, it warmed slowly. Then she went home.

That night she took out the last unfinished figure her father had carved. She held the stylus. And with her own hand, she finished the last side of the figure. For the first time, the stylus settled into her palm with its own weight. Not her father's weight. Hers.

She carries the stylus every cycle now. She no longer blows the tone. Inside the hollow chamber of the handle, there is a small folded slip of pressure-paper. In her own handwriting:

"The calling is over. But I have never forgotten you."

When Erda found this stylus, it lay neatly on a workbench in a stilled work-compartment, far below the residential strata. Beside it, polymer offcuts — the kind no one would carve again — were arranged in a careful row. The slip of pressure-paper was still inside the handle's inner chamber.

Sample 2. Photon Brush (광자 화필)

Field	Content
rarity	Magic (#6969FF · blue)
temperament	Iron (teal · resolve)
item_type	Staff (recovered Builder-era maintenance equipment + isotope-tagged photoluminescent pigment)
inspiration_film	How to Train Your Dragon (the way Gobber's teaching stays alive in Hiccup)
one-line emotion	"So that someone can still find the path after I am gone."
word_count	~900 words

Story

The deep corridors of the megastructure are dark.

In the twenty thousand years since the Builders left, most of the light-circuits they had embedded in the ceilings had gone out. When a surveyor descended into the deep strata, the world reached only as far as their portable lamp. Turn off the lamp, and the world disappeared.

In the Surveyor Guild there was one squad that carried no knife and no hammer. They carried only a brush — a long pole with soft synthetic fibers bound at the tip — and a reservoir, inside the shaft, of isotope-tagged photoluminescent pigment. Painted onto Builder alloy, the pigment held a faint glow for decades. The pigment itself had been recovered from Builder-era maintenance equipment. What the Builders had used it for, even the Guild did not know.

The squad's task was to mark the way. On the bulkheads of corridors the surveyors had passed through safely, they painted small arrows. The arrows told whoever came next: this way is passable. Even when the lamps went out, the arrows could be seen. Among themselves, the squad joked, "We are the surveyors who write."

There was a squad-leader among them. Her name remains in the Guild record, but it will not be spoken here. For forty years, she painted arrows. Her arrows were famous in the Guild. Every line was exactly the same thickness, and every point ended at exactly the same angle. Anywhere in the deep corridors, when someone saw a glowing arrow, they knew: "That is the squad-leader's arrow." Her hand was as precise as Builder alloy.

One year, her hand began to tremble. At first the tremor was almost invisible. The lines of the arrows curved, very slightly. She knew it, but she did not tell her juniors.

The next year, one of her juniors came to her and asked: "Squad-leader, the arrows have been a little different lately. Why?"

She said nothing for a long time. Then she handed the brush to the junior. She set the junior in front of a bulkhead.

"When you paint an arrow with this brush, tremble your hand a little — on purpose."

The junior was puzzled. "Why should I? My hand does not tremble."

The squad-leader said: "After I am gone, someone will still pass through this corridor. When they see a glowing arrow on the bulkhead, what they need to learn is not only the direction of the path. They need to learn that someone passed here before them. A line too clean is a Builder's line. The Builders do not call to people. Only a trembling line is the trace of a person."

The junior did not understand that day. But she did as the squad-leader said, and began to paint arrows with a small, deliberate tremor.

The squad-leader put down her brush for the last time at seventy. Before she left the Guild, she said to the junior, one last thing:

"From now on, your arrows are your arrows. Until your hand begins to truly tremble, tremble it on purpose. And when it begins to truly tremble, do not try to steady it. The next person sees that."

Fifty years later, that junior taught the same words to her own junior. Who taught them to hers. The arrows of the Surveyor Guild have, since then, all trembled a little. That tremor began in one woman's hand and became the language of the whole Guild.

The Guild is mostly dissolved now. But in the deep corridors of the megastructure, those trembling arrows still remain. The isotope has a long half-life. Some arrows were painted a hundred years ago. Some, last year. The shape of each tremor is a little different. But in trembling, they are the same.

When Erda found this brush, it lay against the corner of a bulkhead. On that bulkhead, an arrow had been painted only halfway. The pigment had not yet set, and the final point of the arrow had not been placed. The painter had left before that last point.

When Erda took the brush into her hand, it trembled slightly.

Sample 3. Lost-Object Codex (유실물 기록집)

Field	Content
rarity	Magic (#6969FF · blue)
temperament	Spark (white · curiosity)
item_type	Tome / Off-hand Shield (Builder pressure-paper + survey-grade wax coating)
inspiration_film	Wreck-It Ralph (the dignity of small forgotten things)
one-line emotion	"Small things that were never forgotten."
word_count	~950 words

Story

At Junction-7 of the Surveyor Guild, there was a small desk.

Junction-7 was one of the Builder-era transit intersections, a place where several deep-strata corridors converged. It was the last place where people stopped before turning back up, and the last place where they hesitated before going further down. What the Builders had used the intersection for is no longer known. The Guild simply called it "Junction-7."

The desk belonged to a clerk. She was not a surveyor. Her work was to record the objects that surveyors brought up from the deep strata.

Surveyors descending into the deep often came across small things. An alloy button someone had dropped. A pencil worn down to its end. A hairpin with one tine broken. A glass marble polished by use. An empty medicine vial. The surveyors would place these objects on the desk at Junction-7 and return to their duties. That was one of the Guild's regulations.

"If you find something someone left behind, leave it at Junction-7. So that someone may come back for it."

The clerk's task was to record each object in a codex. The codex was made from Builder-era pressure-paper, bound and laminated with survey-grade wax. Each page was heavy in the hand, and the whole volume, bound together, was as large as a small shield. The pressure-paper had been recovered from a Builder archive. Twenty thousand years had passed, and it had not corroded.

Her records were not like the records of other clerks. She did not only write down the shape of the object or where it had been found. She wrote down the owner, as she imagined them.

"One hairpin, one tine broken. Location: Strata 3, Bulkhead 47. Probable owner: someone who wore their hair in a long braid. Walking close to the bulkheads, the pin must have slipped often; their hand must often have gone to their hair. From the shape of the break, it likely struck the corner of an alloy edge. That day, they were probably in a hurry."

"One glass marble, teal. Location: Strata 4, work compartment. Probable owner: someone with small hands. Too small a marble for an adult's palm. Perhaps a surveyor's child gave it to them as a gift, and the surveyor carried it in a pocket on a deep-strata mission. That day, they had forgotten the weight in their pocket."

"One empty medicine vial, cap closed. Location: Strata 5, rest compartment. Probable owner: someone for whom taking medicine was a daily ritual. That they did not throw the vial away after the last pill suggests that, to them, the vial was no longer a tool but a companion."

The clerk could not know whether her imagined owners were accurate. She had never met any of the people whose objects passed through her desk. Not one of them ever returned to claim what they had left. Junction-7 lay too deep, and those who descended past it rarely came back up.

She kept the codex all her life. Over forty years, nearly ten thousand entries accumulated. The Builder pressure-paper held them all without corroding — as it had held its blank form, unchanged, for twenty thousand years before.

Near the end of her work, her successor arrived. The successor asked her: "Elder, I have been told you never met any of these people. Then why did you imagine their stories every time? The regulation is satisfied even if you write down only the shape of the object."

The clerk handed the codex to the successor.

She said:

"I have never met these people. But I know them. Please, may you also know them."

Before the successor had fully understood her, the clerk had left the desk.

That night, the successor opened the last page of the codex. There was one final entry, written by the clerk.

"One empty seat. Location: the desk at Junction-7. Probable owner: someone who sat in this seat for forty years, recording the stories of the unnamed. They must have known their own name would never be entered into this codex. Yet they sat here every day."

The codex remained on the desk at Junction-7. Between its pages, small objects were tucked in. The wax-laminated pages held them firmly in place.

When Erda took the codex into her hands, it was not heavy. But it was not light, either. It was the weight of ten thousand people leaving ten thousand small things behind. Builder pressure-paper, having taken all of that weight, was now in her hands.

Sample 4. Seam Hammer (이음새 망치)

Field	Content
rarity	Rare (#FFFF00 · yellow)
temperament	Forge (orange · anger)
item_type	Hammer (small, counterweighted, for precision alloy-seam sealing)
inspiration_film	Zootopia (the way one re-shapes a life for a small justice) + Inside Out (protective love)
one-line emotion	"The promise: never again."
word_count	~950 words

Note on Forge tone: Forge is the anger temperament, but not the anger of violence — it is *protective anger*, the heat of a vow: **never again**. Like the warm furnace of a forge, not a fire.

Story

There was a bulkhead repair-worker.

She did not belong to the Guild. Her workshop stood in a corner of Residential Strata 2, and for all her life she stayed in that same place, sealing the small cracks of bulkheads. It was small work. The back wall of a kitchen. The ceiling of a washroom. The corner of a storeroom. Places people walked past every day but almost never looked into.

Far below her workshop, in Residential Strata 5, there was a small habitation cluster. She had never been there. The cluster appeared in the old Guild records only as a footnote, a line or two. She did not know that people lived there. Most of the people in the upper strata went their whole lives without knowing there were people below their feet. The megastructure was too vast, and one person's view was too narrow.

One year, in a cold dormancy, the outer bulkhead seam of that small cluster in Strata 5 gave way. What gave way, and what happened, the Guild record did not detail. It said only that after that day, the cluster had been "depressurized and emptied." The most common ending in the megastructure. When a bulkhead seam opens to vacuum, everything inside is gone in one

breath. The bulkhead closes again. The structure goes quiet again. The Builders had designed the megastructure that way.

A cycle after the bulkhead was resealed, she went down to that cluster. Why she went, even she could not have said exactly.

What she saw in the cluster was not large. In one corner of a bulkhead vent, a single doll's shoe was caught. On the table of one family compartment, a teacup stood; the tea inside had crystallized in the vacuum long before. From a ceiling beam, a small alloy toy hung by a string. Someone's child had been given it, by someone. After the vacuum had ended, it still hung there. As with everything in the megastructure, what had been placed remained placed.

She stood there for a long time.

When she returned to her workshop, she began to make a new hammer. The hammer was smaller than an ordinary repair-worker's hammer. The shaft was short, and the head was small enough to fit in a palm. But the head was filled inside with an alloy counterweight. Small as it looked, a single strike on a Builder alloy seam did the work of three strikes from a normal hammer. It was made for the narrow gaps of the deep strata, for places where other tools could not reach, for the precise tapping of alloy.

She took the hammer and began to descend into the deep strata. The habitation clusters where people lived — among them, the oldest, the least inspected. The weakest places in the megastructure. The places the Builders had built last, and which therefore aged the fastest. She inspected each small seam of bulkhead, one by one, and where the seam had weakened, she tapped it with the hammer and sealed it again. She took no payment. She did not leave her name on the work.

People sometimes asked her: "Why do you do this? You are not in the Guild, and you take no pay. The bulkheads the Builders made will age. No one can stop it."

Her answer was always short.

"Once, I did not know there were people living below me. Now I know. That is all."

She did this work for forty years. The seams she sealed numbered in the thousands. For forty years, the hammer was never handed to anyone else.

By the time her work was finished, her hand had become small. A hand that has held a small hammer all its life does not grow; it shapes itself to the hammer.

The last seam she sealed was the outermost bulkhead of that empty cluster in Strata 5. She went back to that place, forty years later. No one had inspected that bulkhead in all that time.

She sealed her final seam there, and leaned the hammer against the bulkhead.

There, she wrote something on a small piece of pressure-paper and tied it to the hammer. The note was short.

"Now you will know. Please, never again."

When Erda found this hammer, it leaned against the outer bulkhead of the empty cluster. On the seam, the seal from forty years ago and her last seal lay side by side. The bulkhead, silent, showed that the time between the two seals had been forty years.

Erda's hand on the hammer was not a hand the hammer knew. But the hammer was not heavy.

Sample 5. Resonance Fork (공명 굽쇠)

Field	Content
rarity	Magic (#6969FF · blue)
temperament	Shadow (violet · stealth)
item_type	Wand (Builder alloy, precision-cast fork)
inspiration_film	How to Train Your Dragon (deep trust that needs no words)
one-line emotion	"A voice that can be heard even in the dark."
word_count	~1000 words

Note on Shadow tone: Shadow is the stealth temperament, but not the darkness of conspiracy or intrusion — it is the grain of *quiet protection*. Love that does not shout, yet is heard. Secretive, and warm at the same time.

Story

The inner corridors of the Builder structure were long. Some ran so straight you could not see their end; others turned a hundred corners without ever reaching an exit. The bulkheads were all alloy, and above them only old light-circuits the Builders had left behind cast a faint glow. Over twenty thousand years, the light had grown thinner, and some corridors were now entirely dark.

Every parent who lived in a habitation cluster inside the Builder structure carried one small tool. A small alloy fork. It had two prongs and fit in one hand. When you tapped the prongs lightly against a bulkhead, the fork rang a single, exact tone. The tone traveled, vibrating, through the Builder alloy, all the way to the end of the corridor. Builder alloy carried sound well. Whether the Builders had intended this, no one knows. People discovered it, and they used it.

The fork had only one use. To call a lost child.

Inside the Builder structure, children were often lost. The corridors were too long, the corners too many, the markers too few. So every parent learned the fork. But the fork was not a simple tool. Each parent had their own tapping.

Long—short—short. Short—short—long, pause, short. Short—short—short, pause, long—short—short.

This was the secret a parent taught a child. When the child first began to walk, the parent would take their small hand, lead them to a bulkhead, and slowly let them hear their own tapping. "If you hear this sound, that is me."

The child grew, and remembered the tapping. In the dark, in the endless corridors, they would never confuse their own parent's tapping with anyone else's. It was the first thing taught to every child in the habitation clusters of the Builder structure — before letters, before numbers. Letters and numbers were of little use in finding one's way through the megastructure: the signs the Builders had left could no longer be read.

There is the story of one mother.

Her young son was lost, once. The corridor he had wandered into was the outermost in the cluster, almost never used. There the old Builder light-circuits had mostly died out, and the corridor inside was dark. The mother took out her fork and tapped on the bulkhead.

Long—short—short, pause, short.

That was her tapping. The one she had taught him from the time he first began to walk.

She walked along the corridor. After an hour, she tapped again. After another hour, again. There was no reply from her son. She did not call out. To call out would mean she could no longer hear the tone of the fork. That was the first rule every parent in the Builder structure learned.

Two days passed. She did not sleep, and tapped the bulkhead once each hour.

On the night of the third day, she heard a small, faint tapping in the bulkhead.

Long—short—short, pause, short.

It was her own tapping. But she had not made it. Her son, somewhere, had found another fork — and had answered with it.

What her son had found was an old fork, left in an empty room of the Builder structure. A hundred years before, another parent had been tapping there to call their own child, and had left it in that room. Her son took up that fork and tapped her tapping back. Not so that he could find her — but so that she could find him.

The mother followed the sound. Before the night was over, she had found her son. In his hand was a hundred-year-old fork.

She brought that fork back to the habitation cluster. And from then on, she carried it beside her own.

There were many parents like her in the habitation clusters of the Builder structure. One parent might carry two or three forks. A new one, and one or two old ones found somewhere. The old ones, all of them, were forks that someone had once tapped to call their own child, and had left behind.

Generation after generation, every fork absorbed a little of every parent's tapping. Builder alloy remembered vibration deeply. If you held a fork quietly in your hand, sometimes you felt a very faint tremor in your palm. It was the echo of other parents calling other children. Some echoes were a hundred years old. Some, a thousand. Some, perhaps, were the tapplings of the Builders themselves before they left, calling their own children. No one could say for certain. No one even knew whether the Builders had had children.

When Erda held this fork in her hand, she felt the echoes against her palm. They were tapplings she had never heard before. But it seemed to her that she could tell who was calling whom.

Appendix: Writing Principles Drawn From the Samples (For Fina)

Principles that Fina can take from the five samples above and model her own writing on:

A. Emotional Structure Principles (retained from v1)

1. **One person, one emotion.** All five pieces are centered on a single character's single feeling. Even when family or colleagues appear, the point of view stays fixed on one person.
2. **The passage of time is the change itself.** "From seven to forty." "For forty years." "A hundred years ago." Time accumulating is what transforms feeling. The story is moved by time, not by a big event.
3. **The object is a vessel for emotion.** Each item begins as a tool and becomes a condensed form of feeling. In the final scene, the object carries the weight of one person's life by itself.
4. **Erda's discovery is always the last beat.** All five pieces close with "When Erda found this [object]." This closing device aligns with the "drop location" field in SYS-INS-01 v2.0.
5. **No direct depiction of violence or death.** Only indirect expressions: "he did not come home," "depressurized and emptied," "left behind for the last time." Sorrow is evoked through circumstance, not directly shown.
6. **A short sentence to close.** All five pieces end on a short final paragraph. After the accumulation of feeling, the story closes in a single breath.

B. World-Consistency Principles (newly introduced in v2)

7. **The Builders are always in the background.** Every story begins from the vantage point of "twenty thousand years after the Builders left." The Builders are mysterious, but absent. People live within what the Builders left behind.
8. **Tools are salvaged.** The tools the characters use were made for some other purpose in Builder times, and have been reinterpreted by later people for a new use. (E.g., atmospheric seal-tester → signal device for calling lost companions; maintenance pigment → path-marker that glows in the dark.)
9. **Materials are industrial vocabulary.** Alloy, polymer, pressure-paper, isotope, vacuum, ventilation duct, seal. Pre-modern vocabulary such as wood, paper, watercolor, flowers should be avoided. Time-neutral human daily vocabulary — shoes, table, teacup — is allowed.

10. **The disaster is depressurization.** The ending of the megastructure is not flood or fire or explosion, but exposure to vacuum. "Depressurized and emptied" is the standard expression.
11. **Windows are painted skies.** A residential compartment has no real window. There is only another bulkhead in front of it. Someone has painted a sky on it from memory.
12. **Time is exposed in layers.** A character's personal forty years, layered with traces from a hundred years ago, a thousand years ago, layered further with the twenty thousand years since the Builders left — these can all coexist within a single paragraph. The collision of time scales is the emotional grain of the megastructure.